The Sealed Page

Fill the left column in one sitting. Fold it, seal it, write the opening date on the outside.

Sealed on: _____
To be opened: _____
Witnessed by: _____

How to use it. *Left column tonight, in one pass — do not draft, do not improve, do not reread. Then put it in an envelope and write the opening date where you will see it. On that day, fill the right column* ***in a different pen****, and only then read what you wrote. The whole value of this sheet is that you cannot edit the first column later.*

1 WHERE I ACTUALLY AM

Facts, not reflections. These are the ones that will have quietly changed.

	NOW	THEN
The city, the neighbourhood, and who I live with		
What a normal Tuesday looks like		
What is on my nightstand		
The last thing I finished making		
What I actually reach for in my closet		
Who I have seen most this week		
What I am reading, and whether I am enjoying it		
The song I have played into the ground		
What is in my bag right now		
My day rate, if someone asked me today		
The last thing that made me laugh out loud		

2 IN PROGRESS

The unfinished things — the ones a year will either resolve or expose

	NOW	THEN
The project I am most afraid of		
The thing I am avoiding, and why		
What I am waiting to hear about		
The prayer I keep repeating		
What I would change about my work if I could		
Who I am becoming, in three words		

3 PREDICTIONS

Make them falsifiable. A prediction you cannot be wrong about is a mood.

Good seeds: where I will be living · what I will have heard back about, and the answer · what I will have finished · what I will still be putting off · a person I have not met yet · something I am sure of today that I will find funny.

I PREDICT THAT…	SURE? 1–5	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED	✓ / ✗

I PREDICT THAT...	SURE? 1–5	WHAT ACTUALLY HAPPENED	✓ / ✗

4 WHAT I HOPE HAS NOT CHANGED

	NAME IT NOW	STILL TRUE? WHAT DID IT COST TO KEEP?
A person		
A habit or rhythm		
Something I believe		
Something about how I work		
Something small and stupid I love		

5 A LETTER

To whoever opens this — who is, inconveniently, you

Written on the day it was sealed

Tell her what today was actually like. Not the summary — the texture.

Written on the day it was opened

Different pen. Answer her.

6 FOR THE RECORD

Small, dateable, and the first thing memory gets wrong

Three things I am grateful for today

Three things that annoyed me today

Three people I would call right now

OPENED ON

WHERE I WAS

WHO WAS WITH ME